

THE MOTOWN UNIVERSE

Executive Development Memo #012 — Phase 1, Film 3: Release Date & Full Film Sheet

CONFIDENTIAL • An alternate-reality “what if” • Fidelity Rating: 100% • Nerf Tolerance: 0%

HITSVILLE 2

LEAD: Berry Gordy • RELEASE: Friday, May 6, 2011

**Phase 1, Film 3 • The Iron Man 2 role • Motown Productions / Paramount • PG-13 •
approx. 160 min**

A. Release Date: Friday, May 6, 2011

- **It's the MCU slot, one year later.** *Iron Man 2* opened on the first Friday in May 2010. The TMU runs one year behind the MCU (as *Hitsville* did in 2009), so *Hitsville 2* takes the first Friday in May 2011: May 6, 2011.
- **Room for the sequel.** Two years between the first and second *Hitsville* films gives the sequel time to be done right. Gordy opens summer in 2009 and again in 2011.

B. The Iron Man 2 Blueprint Map

Iron Man 2	Hitsville 2 (documented history)
The hero goes public and has to defend his empire	Motown goes national, and Gordy has to defend it at the height of its success
A rival's competing product (Justin Hammer)	The British Invasion. In April 1964 the Beatles hold the top five spots on the Hot 100
A grievance from inside the family (Ivan Vanko)	Mary Wells, Motown's biggest star, leaves at 21 in a contract dispute right after "My Guy" reaches #1
Mortality and legacy (palladium; Howard Stark)	The Gordy family loses Loucye Gordy Wakefield, a Motown executive, in 1965
Black Widow introduced for a future film	Diana Ross, introduced as a young Supreme working in the Hitsville office
Rhodey steps up as War Machine	Smokey Robinson steps up as a Motown vice president and a hitmaker for other artists
Nick Fury and S.H.I.E.L.D. expanded	Motown's artist-development machine and Esther Gordy Edwards' management operation
The Stark Expo showcase	The Supremes' Copacabana engagement in July 1965, when Motown reaches the supper-club mainstream
Post-credits: Thor's hammer	Post-credits: the Prince of Motown (see section 9)

C. Full Film Sheet (Memo #008)

1. Title: *Hitsville 2*

It follows the *Iron Man 2* naming pattern. To the public, it's the sequel to a hit biopic about Motown's founder, which is ordinary for Hollywood and gives nothing away (Memo #007).

2. What's Being Adapted

Source	Used for
Primary: Berry Gordy, <i>To Be Loved</i> (1994)	Gordy's point of view, 1961–1965
Mary Wilson, <i>Dreamgirl: My Life as a Supreme</i> (1986)	The Supremes' rise from "no-hit" to #1
Raynoma Gordy Singleton, <i>Berry, Me, and Motown</i> (1990); Smokey Robinson, <i>Smokey: Inside My Life</i> (1989)	The Gordy–Raynoma story and Smokey's rise as vice president and writer
The master recordings, label credits, and the Billboard chart record	Every song, credit and chart position shown on screen, including the April 1964 Beatles top five

3. What the Movie Is About

Logline: After his first million-seller, Berry Gordy turns Hitsville into a national hit machine, then faces the British Invasion, the loss of his biggest star and a death in the family, all at the peak of his success.

Act One (1961–1962): Hitsville expands into the houses next door on West Grand Boulevard. The Marvelettes' "Please Mr. Postman" becomes Motown's first Hot 100 #1 (Dec. 1961). Smokey Robinson is made vice president. Esther Gordy Edwards builds the company's management arm. The Primettes, now the Supremes, are mocked as the "no-hit Supremes," and Diana Ross takes work in the Hitsville office. Gordy's marriage to Raynoma comes apart.

Act Two (1963–1964): The machine gets sharper. Holland–Dozier–Holland become Motown's hit engine, and artist development teaches its stars to walk, talk and perform. Little Stevie Wonder's "Fingertips" reaches #1 (1963), and Mary Wells' "My Guy," written by Smokey, reaches #1 (1964). Then the Beatles land. In April 1964 they hold the top five spots on the Hot 100, three Motown songs are on their records, and Mary Wells turns 21 and leaves Motown.

Act Three (1964–1965): Gordy bets on the "no-hit" Supremes and HDH. "Where Did Our Love Go" reaches #1 (Aug. 1964), the first of five #1s in a row. In 1965 the family loses Loucy. Grieving but relentless, Gordy takes the Supremes into the Copacabana in New York (July 1965). Motown has answered the British Invasion, and the house on West Grand Boulevard now competes with the whole world.

4. Whose Movie / Franchise It Is

Berry Gordy's. This is his second solo film. The setup for the wider universe never pushes his story aside, which avoids the main criticism *Iron Man 2* received. He's at full strength (No-Nerf): the builder, the gambler and the grieving brother, all as documented.

5. Antagonist

Level	Antagonist	What the record supports
Primary	The British Invasion (1964)	The biggest outside threat Motown ever faced. It's documented in the charts, and the Beatles were also covering Motown songs. Played as a rival force, like Justin Hammer.
Secondary	The Mary Wells contract dispute	Motown's top star leaves at 21, at the worst possible moment. It's a real dispute in which both sides had a case. Wells is not portrayed as a villain.
Internal	Gordy's need for control, and grief	The cost of running everything himself, and the loss of Loucy.

6. Timeline: When & Where

	Setting
When	Early 1961 to July 1965. The fixed points are “Please Mr. Postman” at #1 (Dec. 1961), “Fingertips” (1963), “My Guy” (1964), the Beatles’ top five (April 1964), “Where Did Our Love Go” (Aug. 1964), and the Copacabana (July 1965).
Where	Detroit: the growing Hitsville campus on West Grand Boulevard, including Studio A. New York: the Copacabana.
Master timeline	TMU Chapter Three. It picks up right where <i>Hitsville</i> ends and runs alongside the early years of <i>(I Know) I’m Losing You</i> , sharing some scenes with it (see section 8).

7. Standalone World-Building

- **Motown grows up:** from one house to a row of houses, from a family business to a national corporation.
- **The Gordy family at the top:** Esther, Loucy, Anna and Gwen as executives, and the personal cost of success.
- **A complete story:** the expansion, the threats, the loss and the triumph, with a full ending (40% serialized / 60% standalone).

8. Motown Universe World-Building

Type	Established in Hitsville 2
Returning	Gordy, Smokey, Esther, Raynoma, the Hitsville sets, and Quality Control. The actors who played Mary Wells and the Primettes in <i>Hitsville</i> return, as the continuity rules require.
New characters	Diana Ross, Mary Wilson and Florence Ballard (the Supremes), Holland–Dozier–Holland, the Marvelettes, and Motown’s artist-development staff.
Crossover scene	The late-1964 “My Girl” session, seen from Gordy’s side. It’s the same scene as in <i>(I Know) I’m Losing You</i> , with matching dialogue and staging (Memo #005).
Plot elements	Artist development, HDH as the hit engine, the Motown–Britain connection, and the Supremes’ crossover strategy. These are future-film threads that everyone can see but no one names.

9. Post-Credits Scene: One

Scene	Setting	What happens
End-credits	Studio A, 1961	A “Please Mr. Postman” session. The camera finds the session drummer, a young Marvin Gaye , the same actor as the piano player in <i>Hitsville</i> . He wants to be the next Nat King Cole, not a drummer. The session ends, and he stays at the kit alone and starts to sing.

This mirrors *Iron Man 2*’s single post-credits scene, which teased *Thor*. The TMU’s Thor is a prince, and Marvin Gaye was known as the “Prince of Motown.” **Dependency:** this scene assumes Marvin Gaye leads Phase 1, Film 4, which isn’t decided yet. If Film 4 goes to someone

else, this scene will be rewritten to tease that lead. It's shot under sealed security (Memo #007).

10. How It Kicks Everything Off

N/A. This field is for the first film only (Memo #008).

D. Compliance Check

Mandate	Status
Fidelity (Memo #001)	PASS. Every event, song, credit and date comes from the documented record.
No-Nerf (Memo #001)	PASS. Gordy leads at full strength, and Wells, the Supremes and every other character appear as documented.
Studio (Memos #002–#003)	PASS. Motown Productions, distributed by Paramount.
Phase (Memo #004)	PASS. Phase 1, Film 3 of 6. Released May 6, 2011.
Story model (Memo #005)	PASS. 40% serialized / 60% standalone.
Format (Memo #005)	PASS. Musical Biographical Drama, PG-13, approx. 160 min.
Continuity (Memo #005)	PASS. The same actors and sets return, the shared “My Girl” scene matches Film 2, and the dates fit the master timeline.
Secrecy (Memo #007)	PASS. Publicly marketed as a biopic sequel, with no universe branding.

TMU is a fan-made alternate-reality concept. It has no connection to Motown Records, Universal, Paramount or Marvel Studios. The people named are real. The film and the roles here are fictional.